



PPG INDUSTRIAL TALK ON ENTERPRISE SYSTEM

Summary of the Talk

On Wednesday, 05 November 2025, students of the SECP3744 - Enterprise System and Design Modelling course were privileged to host an informative Industrial Talk in Hyflex Classroom, N28A. The session talked about the Enterprise System Management and Design Best Practice, featured a presentation by Mr. Patrick Thong, the PPG SAP CoE Operating Stream Lead for the Asia Pacific (APAC) region. The talk served as a crucial bridge between academic theory and practical, and offered insights into how multinational corporations like PPG manages its complex digital ecosystem.



PPG's Digital Central Command

Mr. Thong highlights the vast scale of PPG's Enterprise System (ES) landscape. He emphasized that a company's ES is more than just software, but it is also the integrated 'digital brain' that unifies critical global operations. This core system, primarily powered by Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) software, connects and highlights every key function from global manufacturing to financial reporting and human resources management. The ability to maintain data integrity and consistency across this network is fundamental to PPG's global competitiveness.



The Role of the SAP Center of Excellence (CoE)

As the one of the SAP CoE Operation Stream in PPG, Mr. Patrick Thong manages the internal team responsible for the health and evolution of PPG's SAP system. The CoE's core mission is to act as the expert governing body. It ensures the SAP platform runs smoothly, applies the best practices and drives system improvements that directly align with the PPG's strategic business goals.



Key Value Proposition for Students

The shifting focus from theory to real-world application is one of the valuable lessons. The key challenge in ES implementation is not the software itself, but managing the organizational change and standardizing business processes to fit the system. This practical insight prepares for future roles where process alignment is very important as technical knowledge.



Technologies And Issues Discussed

The talk provided an in-depth understanding of how PPG integrates advanced technologies within its SAP ecosystem. Students were introduced to fields such as cloud infrastructure management, enterprise networking, data analytics, robotic process automation, digital science tools, and global IT operations. These technologies work together to support PPG's large-scale digital environment, allowing thousands of processes across the world to run efficiently every day.

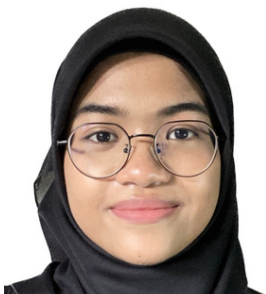
However, Mr. Thong also emphasized that the biggest challenges in enterprise systems are not purely technical. Instead, they arise from the human aspects of global business operations, such as communication barriers across countries, coordinating teams in different time zones, managing expectations between business and technical groups, maintaining standardised processes, and supporting employees through system changes. The session highlighted that while technology forms the backbone of enterprise operations, the success of any system ultimately depends on people's willingness to adapt, collaborate, and learn.



Insights From the Q&A Session

The Q&A session offered many practical insights for students preparing for internships and careers in enterprise technology. Mr. Thong shared that PPG looks for individuals who are curious, willing to learn, and confident in asking questions. While technical skills are important, he emphasized that these can always be taught; what matters more is the ability to adapt, communicate effectively, and maintain a strong work ethic when working with diverse teams across regions.

ERP systems like SAP require close collaboration between functional experts, technical specialists, and business decision-makers. The session reinforced the importance of continuous learning and illustrated how global projects often depend on teamwork, flexibility, and strong analytical capabilities. The guidance shared in this session encouraged students to explore the field of SAP, not only because of its strong job market and career stability but also because of its significant role in transforming businesses around the world.



The talk highlights that Enterprise System (ES) are really about people, not just code.

Nur Firzana Binti Badrus

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As a Year 3 student, this is the biggest lesson for me to prepare for the internship. This practical focus on team alignment and governance where I need to bring it to my internship soon. I learned that my most valuable skill will be helping the business to create efficient and sustainable decisions. This reinforces my motivation to start applying practical knowledge now.



I was truly inspired by how PPG continues to grow as a global leader while consistently improving its systems and strategies, especially through its integration of SAP.

Nurul Adriana Binti Kamal Jefri

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Their continuous commitment showed me that success is built step by step, and nothing is impossible with determination and knowledge. This talk strengthened my confidence in preparing for the internship in the technology field, reminding me that it is better to start learning early and embrace challenges rather than hesitate because of fears or risks that may never happen.

